

Policy Summary: MRI Coverage Policy

Coverage Criteria

MRI lumbar spine is covered when symptoms persist after 6 weeks of conservative treatment and provider documentation supports medical necessity.

MRI lumbar spine requires prior authorization when requested for chronic lower back pain without neurological deficit.

MRI lumbar spine is not covered for routine screening when symptoms do not persist or when conservative treatment has not been attempted.

Medical Necessity

Documentation must include diagnosis, duration of symptoms, conservative treatment history, and clinical rationale.

Exceptions may be reviewed when urgent neurological symptoms are documented by the treating provider.